Chicopee Hills School Council – January 20, 2026

Attendees:
In person: Jenni Guy, Erica Quayle, Caitlin Coverdale, Kat Oue, Colleen Bishop, Bushra Shahid, Arianna DeVries

Online: Kathleen Carr, Amit Trehan, Louise Caswell

Welcome

- Erica

Approval of Minutes from November

- Approved with the correction of the financial numbers
- Motion – Erika, approved by all

School Update

- New VP Bushra Shahid
- Intermediate basketball teams have started
- Choir has continued
- Nov 26 – intermediate classes participated in career hunt
- Grand River band came to perform at the school
- Holiday Market – Dec 5th
- Dec 8-12 was week of giving - did participated in CTV toy mountain as one of charities
- Dec 9th – Gr 7 classes – Sources of Strength Presentation (waterloo suicide group) – to learn sources of strength in their community; had social worker present for kids to ask questions that day
- Winter break
- Jan 14 – guest speaker – Jeff Martin, police officer, talked about positive choices and knowing own value and power of good
- Jan 15th – snow day
- Jan 16th PD day
- This week – Thursday intermediates have trip to Chicopee ski hill
- Friday – celebration photos for Gr 8th
- Jan 29-30 – sidewalk smarts program (student transportation services) – do a day of in class instruction and a sidewalk day and go out and talk about road safety
- Feb 5th – science fair
- Feb 19 – vision screening day for SK students

- Teachers are busy writing report cards, they go out in February
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Hot Topics – 2025 EQAO

- Gr 3 last year (gr 4 this year), 66 participated (96%)
- Gr 6 last year (gr 7 this year) – 69 participated (95%)

Achievement Gr 3

- Reading – at Chicopee - 78% at or above provincial standard, compared to the board 72%, compared to the province standard at the provincial level 74%
- Writing – 69%, compared to 62% board, 64% in province
- Math – 75.8% in school, 62 at board level, 63.8% in province

Achievement Gr 6

- Reading – at Chicopee, 81% at or above provincial level, compared to 85% in board and 85.5% in the province
- Writing – 84.1% compared to 85% and 84% in province
- Math - 56.5% compared to 52% at board and 51% in province

Biggest deficient compared to board and province is in reading
Started program called Rewards – a gap closing program for those who reading scores show some missing pieces (decoding and comprehension)

- Program delivered by teacher (spec ed teacher)
- They are being put into 6–8-week gap closing groups and re-evaluate
- They are multigrade groups – but all the students have needs in similar areas
- So far the kids are really engaged, and home room teachers are seeing kids using the skills that they are being taught

Reading for Junior students

- Using Lexia – testing this with two classes in gr 4
- Once progress through Lexia, will progress to Powerup – to allow students to work above grade level

Financial Update

a) School council funds - $16, 824
b) WEFI = $9, 726.28 ($8,167.80 outdoor learning and $1,558.48 for general)
c) Factory Shoe = $1270.00
d) Mabels Labels = TBD

e) Poinsettias = TBD
f) Holiday market = TBD
g) Current staff requests for purchases

Fundraising and Event Updates

a) Canopies – available to order through Amazon, but not approved to use Amazon to purchase this from the board; best bet is to buy one from a store; looking at a green one that we can attach a school banner to
b) Holiday Market wrap up – the day went well; vendors were pleased with how it went but didn't make as much as they thought they would; they were pleased about the free pizza; more vendors this year and the variety of vendors were really good; the attendance was down (? At the same time as other events and decreased signage this year)
c) Poinsettia wrap up – sold 20 less than the previous year; majority is purchased by Stanley Park community centre; question is if this fundraiser is worth it to do again
d) Science fair update – 122 kids signed up; given out a board for every student that wanted a board; would like to print certificates in colour for every participant (use M&T to print those); had a large response for volunteers (about 30 people) and have two parents to be present during the day; biggest concern is for the kids that aren't coming back in the evening to take the projects home with them – to organize the left over projects in the library for pickup the next day
e) Air bands – similar to every year, getting pizza from Papa John's; requesting support from staff – from March until the evening of
f) Book fair (Caitlin) – deliver Feb 19th, runs 23-27th of Feb, take down on Feb 27th; to do an evening again – the Tuesday and Thursday, keep it open until 6 pm for parents; does need volunteers to help with the book fair. To look at using funds generated from the book fair to support literacy in the classroom.
g) Staff appreciation –(in March), discuss next month; week after March break (Arianna)
h) Media Club – still running; to work on book fair posters, science fair posters are already up
i) What are we fundraising for? Big Project? – Sign – repair sign or replace with a new sign; will get company out to look at the sign and then will vote on it next meeting
j) Trees in the back – received a grant $1500 to help pout more trees there; also wanted to put benches there as well, to do some research to see what the cost of those are and see if parent council can fund those (buddy benches) – Arianna to look into this

Next Meeting - February 17th